

the Area we belonged to and found other groups who were also feeling the same way and formed our own Area. A solution. We started to serve the needs of the groups instead of the wants of the service workers. We decided also not to belong to a Region at this time and not to belong to the World Service Conference. Some will ask, "How do you get literature then?" Our answer is that we print our own. It is the right of the Group. This might upset some people and cause great harm. This has not gone without notice. We also would like to thank all those who have been in support of us the last few years. Your support was needed. This also has not gone without notice. You let us know that we're not alone. Narcotics Anonymous, you are beautiful.

The Traditions are the answers, not the concepts.
More will be revealed.

Anonymous
Written 1992



Alternate Service Information Structure

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OUR UNITY LIES IN OUR DIVERSITY.

Written by a member of Historical Perspective
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Our unity lies in our diversity. *“The greater the base, as we grow in unity in numbers and in fellowship, the broader the sides and the higher the point of freedom.”* {p. xi Basic Text, 3rd Ed. Revised}.

“Goodwill is best exemplified in service and proper service is ‘doing the right thing for the right reason.’ When this supports and motivates both the individual and the fellowship, we are fully whole and wholly free.”

We hear a lot about unity in our fellowship. What does the word “unity” mean? Or is it just a word we throw around to get people to believe in our cause? We also hear the word “disunity” utilized in our fellowship through our continued on page 5service structure. Who is causing the disunity? The ones pointing the finger or the ones the fingers are being pointed at. Our Traditions tell us how to deal with internal controversy, the problems that may arise out of our inability to communicate with each other at times. The Traditions of the fellowship of NA are like the Constitution and the Bill of Rights of the United States of America. Without them we would be in slavery. There would be no fellowship. Over a period of time, after looking back on our history, one must wonder if we have ever followed the Traditions. The controversy which seems to have always existed in the fellowship is just a way for the disease to manifest itself within Narcotics Anonymous.

The best way for the disease to exist is to divide us through service alignments, to tell us that we have the answers and that if you disagree that you are causing disunity. We do this in the name of group conscience, and group conscience must be right. After carefully reviewing the Second Tradition it was found to my surprise that it states, “We must be constantly on guard that our decisions are truly an expression of God’s will. There is often a vast difference between group conscience and group opinion,

as dictated by powerful personalities or popularity.” [p.59 3rd Ed Rev.]

So we ask who is right or who is wrong? Does there always have to be a right or wrong? Do we have the ability to think for ourselves or do we need someone to do the thinking for us? I personally have no answers, just questions. The longer I stay clean, the more questions I have. Some of - the questions I’ve asked myself are, What are the solutions, who has them, do I really have to be involved to stay clean, why can’t I be just like the next guy, do we really need the service structure, and if so why? Is there a way to change the service structure without being listed as a “disunities”? If so, how? It gets really lonely at times thinking I am the only one thinking this way but I know it’s a lie because I’ve had other people share the same experience with me so I’m not alone.

I think there are other people out there who are thinking the same thoughts I have had and just don’t know where to go with them or just don’t know how to find the solutions to fix the problem. I spent most of my recovery involved in the known service structure frustrated and finally got to the thought, maybe I am wrong and what is the use anyway. Maybe it’s the time just to get along with my personal life anyway. Maybe I’m wrong and crazy. Did anyone ever have them thoughts? You’re not alone anymore. There are other solutions. The Traditions are the answers, not the concepts.

The home group I belong to decided a year and 7 months ago that it could not participate in the known service structure, that if we were to continue to call ourselves Narcotics Anonymous that it was time we stopped negotiating our Traditions to go along with the status quo. The 12 Traditions are not negotiable [p.56 3rd Ed Rev.]. So why were we negotiating them? We left